

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ J

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣ K

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦ 8

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦ Q

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠ 4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 2
♥ 10 6
♦ K Q 2
♣ K 10 8 7 5

♠ K J 8 7 4

♥ K 7 2

♦ A 9 5

♣ A Q



♠ 10 5
♥ A Q J 4
♦ J 10 7
♣ J 6 4 3

♠ A 6 3

♥ 9 8 5 3

♦ 8 6 4 3

♣ 9 2

SOUTH has a terrible hand, and naturally passes.

NORTH, however, has a nice 18 points and opens 1 ♠.

SOUTH still has a terrible hand, and passes again. You need at least 6 points to respond to an opening one bid.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
Pass	1 ♠		Pass
All Pass			
1 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ A 7

♠ A 8

♥ J 10 9

♦ A 10 3

♣ 10 5 4 3 2



♠ K Q J 5 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ J 8 6

♠ 7 2

♥ 8 6 5 3 2

♦ J 8 7

♣ K Q 9

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣K

EAST has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

WEST has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣. It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠

EAST cannot bid game yet, after all, WEST could have as few as 6 points. But she can continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that WEST actually has 9 or 10 points.

WEST comes through with 4 ♠.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 9
♥ 10 3
♦ Q 9 8 5
♣ K 9 7 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ K 6 2

♣ A Q 3



♠ A 5 4 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 3

♣ J 10 6 4

♠ K J 6

♥ K J 8 5 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ 8 5

SOUTH has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1♥.

NORTH has 11 points and good ♥ support so she jumps to 3♥.

SOUTH knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by South

Lead: ♦8

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 3
 ♥ A K Q 7 2
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ 10 9 5

♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 5 4 2

♣ K 6 2



♠ Q J

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ Q J 7

♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 9 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 4 3

EAST has 11 points and she should pass.

WEST has a minimum 1♥ opening, 13 points and five trumps.

EAST, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3♥.
 (This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but WEST can add and he knows the total points will be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3♥.

West	North	East	South
1♥		Pass	Pass
3♥ by West	Pass	3♥	
Lead: ♦Q			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 5
♥ J 9 8
♦ A K 6 2
♣ J 8 3

♠ K Q 10 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6



♠ 4

♥ 10 6 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ K Q 9 5 2

♠ J 9 6 2

♥ K Q 7 5

♦ 8 3

♣ 10 7 4

NORTH has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

SOUTH has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠.

NORTH passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. SOUTH can have a maximum of 10 points, which would only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by North

Lead: ♠4